

WEEK 1

SPEECH

TOPIC: Intonation Pattern Rise and Fall

Intonation is the rise and fall of the voice in speech or the variation in speech while speaking. It gives special meaning and emphasis to utterances.

FUNCTIONS OF INTONATION

1. **Grammatical function:** This is used to differentiate between specific sentence types – declarative, interrogative, polar questions etc. when a speaker wants to give information, the falling tone is used.
2. **Attitudinal function:** The attitude can be that of surprise, doubt, sarcasm, interest, indifference, disbelief, uncertainty. For instance, when a speaker answers “Yes” in reply to a question, different shades of meaning can be inferred. If given in a falling tone means affirmation, meaning there is no doubt. But when it is given in a rising tone, it suggests some reservations (doubt) in the speaker's mind.

TYPES OF INTONATION

- a. The falling tone
- b. The rising tone
- c. The rise and fall tone

A. THE FALLING TONE

This is used to indicate a fall in the pitch of a speaker's voice. In writing, we use the downward arrow to show a sentence uttered with the falling tone “↓”

USES OF FALLING TONE

- a. To make statement. Examples;
 - i. We shall all pass English language ↓
 - ii. The teacher is coming ↓
- b. To give commands. Examples;
 - i. Shut the door ↓
 - ii. Stand up ↓
- c. To make exclamations. Examples;
 - i. What a pleasant surprise! ↓

- ii. Oh my Goodness! ↓
- d. WH-Questions. Examples;
 - i. When are you coming? ↓
 - ii. Why are you late to school? ↓

B. RISING TONE

This is used to indicate a rise in the pitch of a speaker's voice.

USES OF THE RISING TONE

- a. For asking questions requiring a "Yes or No" answers otherwise known as polar questions. Examples;
 - i. Is this your book? ↑
 - ii. Are you coming? ↑
- b. For polite request. Examples;
 - i. May I borrow your book please? ↑
 - ii. Could you tell me the time please? ↑
- c. For greetings. Examples;
 - Good morning sir ↑
 - Complement of the season ↑
- d. To indicate uncertainty
 - Will John come to school tomorrow? ↑
 - Can she make it? ↑
- e. For incomplete statements. Examples;
 - While they were playing ↑
 - As I was saying ↑

C. THE RISE AND FALL TONE

USES

- a. This tone is used in making a list of items. The voice pitch begins listed while the last item receives a falling tone.
 - Examples
 - i. One ↑, two ↑, three ↑, four ↑ and five ↓.
 - ii. Go in with a pen ↑, pencil, a ruler and an eraser ↓
- b. It is also used in tag questions. Examples,
 - You can do it, can't you ↑
 - She is hardworking ↓, isn't she? ↑

Assignment

Exercise on unit 13

Question 3 page 173

Read and indicate the appropriate intonation